Lesson 15: Listening and Speaking: An Interview About a Job

English Stage 1 (B1) · Unit 2: Getting to Know You

Adapted from Speaking, Listening and Pronunciation Projects for ELLs - Intermediate Level by Brittany Zemlick, Grossmont College (CC BY 4.0): 2.1: Listening and Speaking- Interview - Andy's Job; 2.2: Vocabulary Review.

In this lesson

You will watch a short video interview with Andy, a farmer who cares about the environment. You will learn words about farming and the environment, listen for the main idea and then for details, and write the questions an interviewer asks about a person's job.

Learning goals

After this lesson you should be able to:

- Use words about farming and the environment, such as "plant crops", "harvest" and "sustainable".
- Understand the main idea and the details of a short interview.
- Name the genre, audience and purpose of a video.
- Ask and answer questions about a person's job, daily tasks and values.

Key language

Word or phrase	Meaning in simple English	Example
sustainable	can continue for a long time; it is not used up or destroyed	Windmills and solar panels are sustainable energy sources.
sustainable agriculture	farming that does not damage the environment, so we can grow food in the future	Andy practices sustainable agriculture.
industrial agriculture	farming with very large numbers of plants and animals, to sell for food	This kind of farming can damage the environment.
values	the things that are most important to you in life	Your values can include family, money, education, music or art.
plant crops	put seeds in the ground so they grow into food	Andy plants crops on his farm.
harvest	pick the fruits and vegetables when they are ready	Andy picks the vegetables on his farm: he harvests them.
produce (noun)	fresh fruits and vegetables	Fresh vegetables are produce.
challenging	difficult, but maybe interesting or enjoyable	Is your job challenging?
pollute	make water, air or land dirty	Trash, oil and chemicals pollute the water.

Rules and explanations

Listening in two steps

- First for the **main idea** (the big picture): watch once without stopping.
- Then for **details** (names, places, numbers): watch again, and stop and replay when you need to.

Genre, audience and purpose

- **Genre**: what kind of video it is (an interview, a movie, a presentation...).
- **Audience**: who will watch it.
- **Purpose**: why someone made it (to teach, to persuade, to show an example...).

Interview questions about a job

The detail questions are about Andy ("he"). An interviewer asks the same questions with "you":

About Andy	To the person
Where did he grow up?	Where did you grow up?
Where does he live now?	Where do you live now?
What does he do every day?	What do you do every day?
Why does he like his job?	Why do you like your job?
Does he have any pets?	Do you have any pets?

- Present simple questions: **does** with he/she/it, **do** with I/you/we/they. The main verb stays in the base form: "What does he do?" (not "What does he does?").
- Short answers: "Yes, he does." / "No, he doesn't."
- Past questions: **did** + base verb: "Where did he grow up?" (not "grew").

> **Note for Arabic speakers** - Arabic questions do not use "do/does/did". In English you need them: "Where does he live now?" (not "Where he lives now?"). - Arabic has no /p/ sound. Practise /p/ as in "pen" and /b/ as in "bag" with "plant", "pull", "pickup", "produce" and "public".

Practice

1. Before you watch. Answer aloud in 2 or 3 sentences: a) Andy is a farmer. What do you think he does every day? b) Andy practices sustainable agriculture. What is sustainable agriculture? If you don't know, guess. c) What are your values?

2. Vocabulary. Task 2 in your material uses pictures. Instead, write the word for each definition from that table. Choose from: pull weeds, challenging, vegan, meat production, destroy, habitat, podcast.

1. raising animals for food
2. remove unwanted plants
3. a radio or music program you can download to your phone or computer from the internet

4. something that is difficult but may be interesting or enjoyable
5. a place where animals live
6. to cause something to end or no longer exist
7. a person who does not eat food that comes from animals (milk, meat, eggs)

3. Watch for the main idea. Watch the video once (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wa0582oOYgY) and take notes. What does Andy do every day in his job? What are his values?

4. Listen for detail (book interactive exercise). Watch again and choose.

1. What's the man's name? _____
2. Where did he grow up? Oxford / San Diego / El Cajon
3. Where does he live now? Oxford / San Diego / Scotland
4. How many brothers and sisters does he have? 1 / 2 / 3
5. Where are his parents from? England and Poland / El Cajon and San Diego / Scotland and Poland
6. What's his job? He's a farmer. / He's a teacher. / He's a vegan.
7. What does he do every day? He waters plants. / He pulls weeds. / He plants crops. / He repairs fences. / All of the answers are correct.
8. What does he like about his job? Choose all correct answers: (a) being outdoors in a beautiful place (b) working to improve the environment (c) office work (d) working with the public
9. What doesn't he like about his job? Choose all correct answers from (a) to (d).
10. Which one is NOT his hobby? cooking / running / playing the guitar / listening to podcasts / riding his bike
11. Does he have any pets? Yes, he does. / No, he doesn't. / He lives in a house with two cats.
12. What kind of car does he drive? a pickup truck / a Toyota Camry / a Jeep
13. Does he like waking up early in the morning? Yes, he does. / No, he doesn't.
14. Why doesn't he eat meat? He doesn't like the taste of meat. / He feels that eating meat hurts the environment. / He eats meat every day.
15. What are the most important things in his life? His family and making the world a better place / Running and playing music / Family, money, and cooking

5. After you watch. Choose and say why. a) Genre: a TikTok video / a movie / a presentation / an interview b) Most likely audience: young children in school / young people who like to travel / teachers / ESL students c) Purpose: to teach children about farmers / to persuade people to become vegans / to model an interview for English language students d) Would you like to have a job like Andy's? Why or why not? Record your answer and listen back.

6. Your interview questions. If you interviewed a friend or family member about their job, what questions would you ask? Write at least 8. Then ask your tutor for 3 more good questions and add them to your list.

7. Vocabulary review A (book). Use: sustainable, industrial agriculture, values, plant crops, pull weeds, water, harvest, pickup truck, repair, produce. Spell correctly.

1. I need to _____ the plants in the garden. It's very dry and hot today.
2. Andy drives a _____. He uses it for his farming business.
3. Many people buy _____ from the grocery store, but you can also grow fruits and vegetables at home.
4. Wind energy is _____ because we can use it forever and it will never run out.
5. Farmers usually _____ in the spring. They put seeds in the ground and wait for them to grow into food.
6. Farmers usually _____ crops in the fall. They pick the fruits and vegetables and then eat them or sell them.
7. In the video, Andy talks about his _____. The most important things in his life are family and protecting the environment.
8. If you _____ something, that means you're fixing it.
9. _____ means growing large amounts of vegetables, fruit, and animals, usually in a relatively small space.
10. Gardeners _____ (remove plants they don't want) to make room for the plants they want to grow.

8. Vocabulary review B (book). Use: podcasts, challenging, vegan, environmental impact, meat production, pollutes, carbon, habitats, fences.

1. A _____ is a person who doesn't eat meat or use animal products.
2. Andy says working with the public can be _____.
3. I like to listen to _____ on my iPhone.
4. Industrial agriculture is bad for the environment because it _____ waterways.
5. If we destroy the _____ of animals, they won't have a place to live.
6. Industrial agriculture and some forms of energy production release _____ into the atmosphere.
7. _____ is the process of raising animals to use them for food.
8. Many people are concerned about the _____ of airplanes.
9. Farmers have to put _____ around their crops so that animals won't eat them.

Speak with your tutor

- "You are Andy, the farmer from the video. I will interview you about your job, your family and your values. Answer, and tell me if one of my questions has a mistake."
- "Interview me about my job or my studies. Ask one question at a time, and ask one follow-up question after each answer."
- "Here are my 8 questions to interview a friend about their job. Check the grammar of each one and tell me which questions are the best and why."
- "Let me retell Andy's interview in 6 to 8 sentences. Correct my mistakes, especially does and doesn't."

Read aloud

1. Where did you grow up? (↘)
2. What do you do every day? (↘)
3. Do you have any pets? (↗)
4. Does he like waking up early in the morning? (↗)
5. sus·TAIN·a·ble AG·ri·cul·ture
6. HAR·vest·ing, HAB·i·tat, en·VI·ron·ment
7. Andy says working with the public can be CHAL·leng·ing.

Watch online

- Andy's job interview (watch two times: main idea, then details): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Wao582oOYgY
- Quizlet flashcards for this lesson's words: https://quizlet.com/513489336/interview-andys-job-flash-cards/

Answer key

1. (example answer) a) I think he plants and waters vegetables. b) Maybe it is farming that protects the environment. c) My family, my health and education.

2. 1 meat production; 2 pull weeds; 3 podcast; 4 challenging; 5 habitat; 6 destroy; 7 vegan.

3. (book) He waters plants, pulls weeds, plants crops and repairs fences. His values: his family and making the world a better place.

4. (book) 1 Andy; 2 Oxford; 3 San Diego; 4 2; 5 Scotland and Poland; 6 He's a farmer.; 7 All of the answers are correct.; 8 (a) and (b); 9 (c) and (d); 10 riding his bike; 11 He lives in a house with two cats.; 12 a pickup truck; 13 No, he doesn't.; 14 He feels that eating meat hurts the environment.; 15 His family and making the world a better place.

5. a) an interview: one person asks questions and Andy answers. b) ESL students. c) to model an interview for English language students. d) (example answer) Yes, I would. I like being outdoors and I want to help the environment. But I don't like waking up early!

6. (example answer) Where do you work? What do you do every day? How long have you worked there? What do you like about your job? What don't you like about it? Why is your job important to you?

7. (book) 1 water; 2 pickup truck; 3 produce; 4 sustainable; 5 plant crops; 6 harvest; 7 values; 8 repair; 9 industrial agriculture; 10 pull weeds.

8. (book) 1 vegan; 2 challenging; 3 podcasts; 4 pollutes; 5 habitats; 6 carbon; 7 meat production; 8 environmental impact; 9 fences.

My notes